Disann Katende MPH
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Skills

- SQL, R, SAS: Big data management, querying, wrangling, visualization (ggplot, R Shiny dashboards)
- Geospatial analysis: ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, geocoding, cluster & hotspot analysis (Getis-Ord Gi*)
- Electronic Data Capture: REDCap, Kobo, Voxco, Qualtrics, ODK, EHR data security and standards.
- Statistical Analysis: descriptive, glm, geeglm, coxph, lme4, nlme, ANOVA, hypothesis testing (R, SAS, Py)
- Disease surveillance, Public Health Monitoring, and Evaluation

Experience

Pacific Region Representative – CIHR Community Advisory Committee 02/2026- to date
Canadian Institutes of Health Research (CIHR) / Public Health Agency of Canada (PHAC)

- Represent community perspectives from the Pacific Region on national health research initiatives and priorities.
- Advise CIHR and PHAC on community-identified research needs, challenges, and emerging public health issues.
- Convene and engage community leaders, researchers, and health experts to gather input on research priorities and policy development.
- Facilitate knowledge exchange between community organizations, researchers, and PHAC to strengthen community-informed research.
- Provide strategic feedback on research proposals, funding priorities, and community engagement approaches.

Research Epidemiologist: WHO -Vaccination against Emerging and Neglected Infectious Diseases| 01/2025 – to date
I collaborate with Dr.Khumbo Kalua to investigate spatial distribution and systemic barriers to Onchocerciasis Mass Drug Administration (MDA) coverage across 238, clusters in Southern Malawi.

- Spatial Analysis: Analyzed spatial clustering patterns of treatment and successfully identified spatial dependency using Global Moran's I.
- Advanced Statistical Modelling: Built statistical models to mitigate cluster-level and spatial dependencies.
- Data Dissemination & Policy Support: Built interactive dashboards mapping district-level variances and uptake predictors to target operational bottlenecks and optimize public health resources.

Methodologist | Smart Discharges - Institute for Global Health |11/2024 - 12/2025

- Collaborated with Dr.Matthew Wiens to apply quantitative and geospatial analysis in predictive models for region-specific interventions to improve post-discharge outcomes in children (under 5s) with sepsis in East Africa
- Performed survival analysis to investigate predictors of mortality and recovery after hospital discharge in pediatric sepsis cases.

Research Analyst | CAREX Canada |BC Centre for Disease Control – UBC 10/2022 – 01/2025

- Collaborated with Dr.Cheryl Peters, investigated the effect of air pollution on cancer in the Statistics Canada Secure Research Data Centre (RDC)- Conducted geospatial analysis linking air pollutants with cancer incidence in Canada.
- Produced high-quality maps and data visualizations for dissemination to stakeholders and policymakers.
- Air pollution ($PM_{2.5}$, NO_2 & Ozone) and cancer outcomes:
    - Linked Statistics Canada's National Household Surveys, Cancer registry and Canadian Census Health and Environment Cohorts (CanCHEC 1991, 1996, 2001 & 2006) and managed large analytical datasets (>100 million rows)
    - Performed extensive data cleaning and wrangling of Environmental health data using R
    - Applied advanced statistical modelling (Cox proportional hazards, multilevel modelling and geospatial methods) to examine the effect of air pollution and other determinants on the outcome of 8 cancers: Lung, Brain, Renal, Pancreatic, Breast, Prostate, Urinary Bladder, and Leukemia
- Examined carcinogen exposures among new workers in Canada: link
- Performed quantitative and geospatial analyses for various occupational and environmental exposures (sun safety and shade initiatives in BC and lifeguards in Ontario, lead (Pb) exposure in drinking water in BC schools)

Senior Coordinator - Data Collection and Analysis | First Nations Health Authority | 10/2022 - 1/2023

- Led the design and implementation of the First Nations Regional Health Survey (RHS) across British Columbia, managing field logistics, enumerator training, and stakeholder engagement.
- Oversaw all aspects of data administration and management, including collection, validation, analysis, and dissemination, while upholding OCAP principles and strict data security, privacy, and confidentiality standards.

Data Analyst & Coordinator | The Collaboration for Research Excellence in Africa (Core Africa-UK) | 12/21-03/23

- Led Electronic Data Capture (EDC) using REDCap and complex data analysis on cancer and nutrition studies using SAS and R
- Implemented EDC system for health research projects, enhancing data collection efficiency, accuracy, and security; streamlined data entry processes, enabling real-time monitoring and validation checks to ensure data integrity, seamless data management, and analysis

Research Data Analyst | BC Children's Hospital Research Institute | 08/2020 - 08/2021

- Conducted statistical analyses on complex pediatric conditions and metabolic diseases using R
- Data management for Gabapentin - Randomized Controlled Trial

Student Intern | Health Data Research Network | 08/2020 - 03/2021

- Participated in developing data standards, methods, and management procedures for electronic health record (EHR)
- Oriented researchers on data linkages and flow within the Secure Research Environment (SRE) systems

Guest Lecturer | **International Nutrition, University of British Columbia, Canada |** 01/2021-04/2021

- Provided students with vital real-world life insights based on Community-based Management of Acute Malnutrition (CMAM)

Project Manager (Sustainability Scholar) | **Campus Food Security, University of British Columbia|** 09/2020-04/2021

- Led projects including developing and launching online surveys on Qualtrics to deepen knowledge on food security within the University context and guide programming for optimal nutrition outcomes on campus

Jr. Nutrition Advisor | SNV Netherlands Development Organization | 02/2018 – 07/2018

- Led the development of study designs, data collection instruments, and analysis plans to improve dietary diversity in western Uganda.

Nutrition Consultant | Protecting Families against HIV/AIDS (PREFA) Uganda | 11/2016– 12/2017

- Led technical design, implementation, monitoring & evaluation of HIV/AIDS and nutrition interventions to deliver high-quality research in high-volume sites in central Uganda

Health and Nutrition Technical Officer | World Vision International Uganda | 07/2016– 11/2016

- Led multi-sectoral assessments and community-based surveys to inform program implementation across Health & Nutrition and WASH.
- Coordinated MNCAH/HIV/AIDS and Health Systems Strengthening (HSS) activities with the Ministry of Health, integrating survey data into regional planning efforts.

Emergency Nutritionist | **UNICEF-Concern Worldwide | Westnile & Karamoja, Uganda |** 05/2014 – 12/2015

- Conducted food security and nutrition assessments in alignment with the IPC Protocols for Acute Food Insecurity
- Led nutrition surveillance using the SMART methodology to evaluate the nutritional status in UN-refugee sites (S.Sudanese)
- Conducted food security and nutrition assessments in the West Nile and Karamoja regions.
- Led GIS-based surveillance for malnutrition hotspots in West Nile and Karamoja
- Developed maps and reports for humanitarian response planning.

Publications

Katende D, Rydz E, Quinn EK, Heer E, Shrestha R, Fazel SS, Peters CE. 2024. 'Overrepresentation of new workers in jobs with multiple carcinogen exposures in Canada.' *Int J Environ Res Public Health*; 21(8):1013. Doi: https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph21081013

Larsen K, Katende D, Shrestha R, Peters CE "Exploring socio-spatial inequities for lead in drinking water: An assessment of lead exposure for public schools in British Columbia". (*under review Manuscript Number:* ***HEHA-D-25-00090***)

Shrestha R, Katende D, Tenkate T, Peters CE. 'Adherence to best practices for sun protection among Toronto, Canada lifeguards.' Submitted

Awards

- Graduate Mastercard Foundation Scholarship at the University of British Columbia, Vancouver (2018-2021)
- Student Delegate - Global Nutrition and Food Security at the Chicago Council on Global Affairs (2019)
- UBC Sustainability Scholars -Campus Food Security (2020)
- Undergraduate Government Merit Full Scholarship: (2008-2012)

Education

Master of Public Health: University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
Bachelor of Science (Food Science and Technology): Makerere University